

Cat Wire Chewing Danger — Action Checklist

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AUDIT YOUR HOME'S CORDS

- ☐ **Audit Your Home's Cords:** Walk through every room in your home and get on the floor to locate every cord, including hidden ones under furniture, behind appliances, and along baseboards that your cat can access.
- ☐ **Audit Your Home's Cords:** Categorize each cord by three factors: whether your cat can currently reach it, whether it's plugged in and carrying electrical current, and how critical the device is to your daily function.
- ☐ **Audit Your Home's Cords:** Identify commonly overlooked cord locations such as USB cables beside the bed, phone chargers on nightstands, ethernet cables running along floors, and kitchen appliance cords that pose hidden risks.
- ☐ **Audit Your Home's Cords:** Create a prioritized protection plan based on your audit, starting with the highest-risk cords your cat can reach while plugged in, so you don't waste time protecting cords that aren't immediate threats.

INSTALL PHYSICAL BARRIERS

- ☐ **Install Physical Barriers:** Wrap your most vulnerable cords in braided PET cable sleeves, which provide significant resistance against cat teeth and work best for desk areas, entertainment centers, and bedside charging stations.
- ☐ **Install Physical Barriers:** Install cord channels or raceways along baseboards and walls to completely conceal cords and eliminate access, making it impossible for your cat to reach them.
- ☐ **Install Physical Barriers:** Apply cat-safe citrus-based or commercial deterrent sprays specifically designed for cats instead of bitter apple spray, which does not work on determined chewers, and reapply weekly.
- ☐ **Install Physical Barriers:** Elevate cords off the floor using cable clips or cable trays wherever possible, because cords running along floors are the easiest targets for persistent cats to access and chew.

ADDRESS THE ROOT BEHAVIOR

- ☐ **Address the Root Behavior:** Provide appropriate teething and chewing alternatives like frozen washcloths, cat grass, or catnip toys to redirect your cat's chewing instincts away from electrical cords.
 - ☐ **Address the Root Behavior:** Give your cat interactive play sessions and enrichment activities daily to reduce boredom-driven cord chewing, because bored cats seek stimulation through destructive behaviors like gnawing on wires.
 - ☐ **Address the Root Behavior:** Stay calm and avoid rushing over or yelling when you catch your cat chewing a cord, because reacting with attention reinforces the behavior even when that attention is negative.
 - ☐ **Address the Root Behavior:** Consult your veterinarian about compulsive cord chewing if redirection and barriers fail, because cats with true pica may need dietary intervention or behavioral medication to stop the behavior.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.